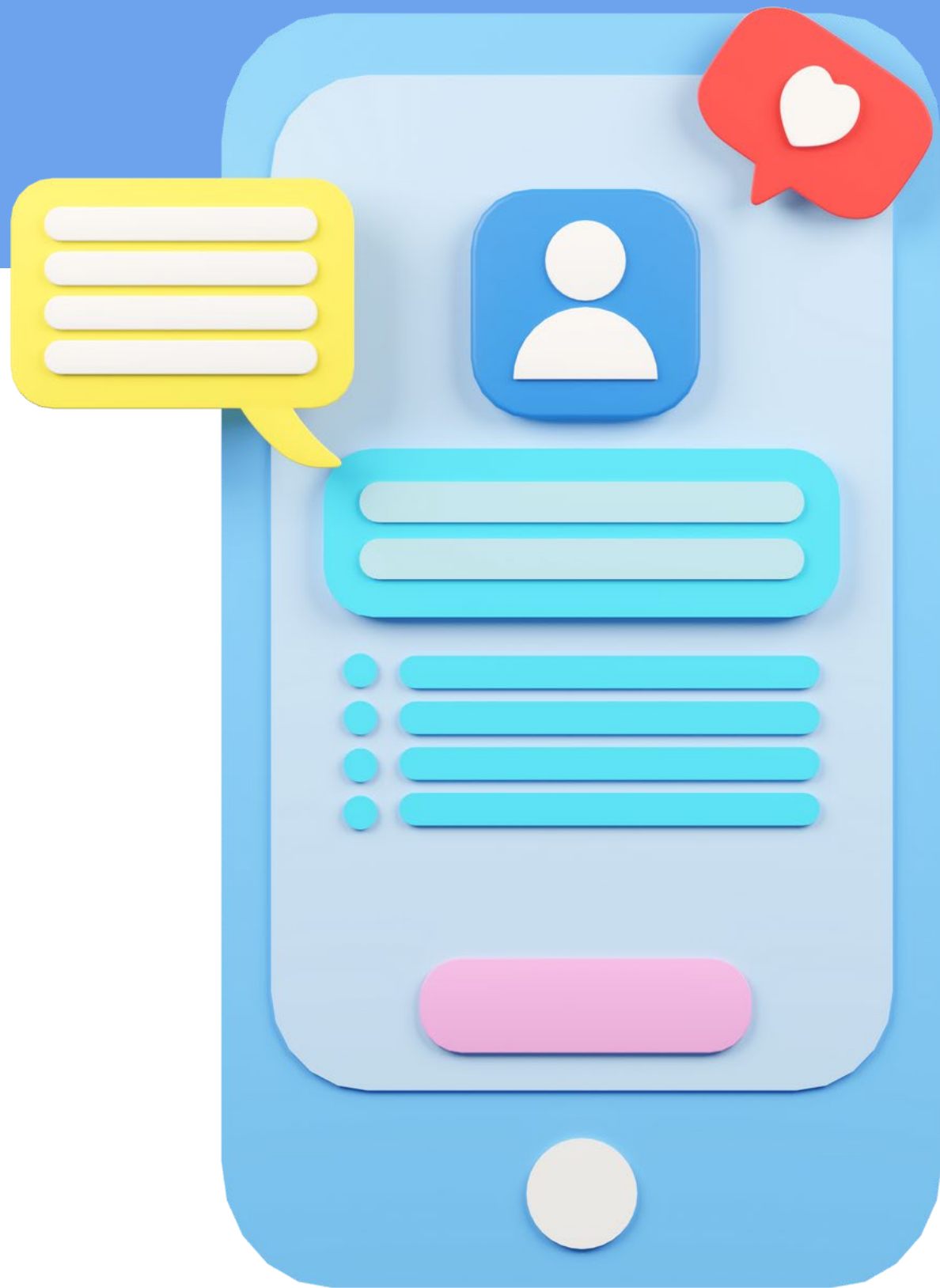


ARCHIVING DIGITAL EPHEMERA



INSTAGRAM
INTO THEIR



✨ Hello and ✨
good morning!

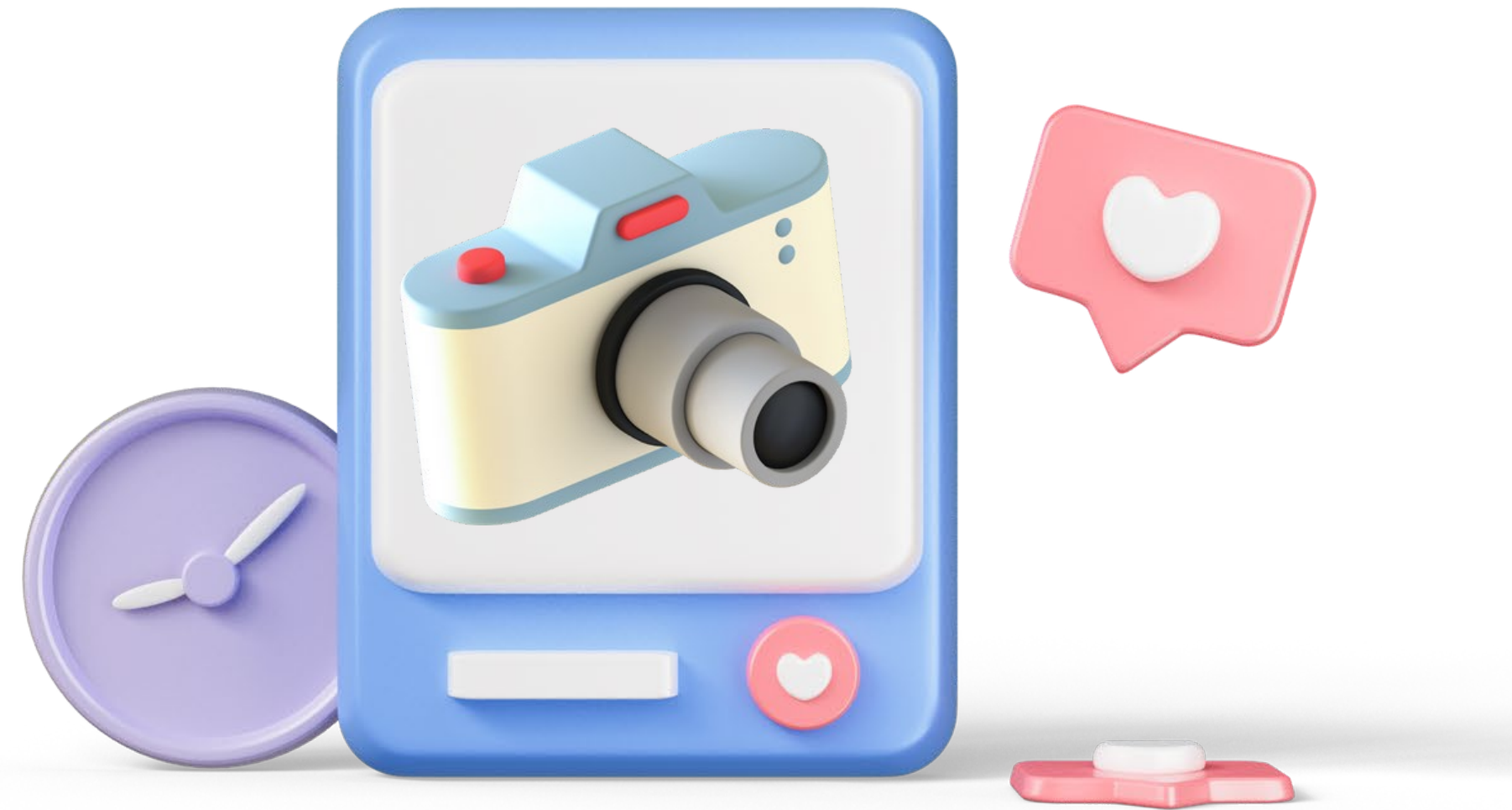
I'm Helena Marvin
Reference & Institutional
Repository Librarian at the
University of Missouri-St. Louis



UMSL Libraries
University of Missouri–St. Louis

IRL @ University of Missouri–St. Louis
Institutional Repository Library

AGENDA



What

- Instagram is a social media platform on which my library and my university has been sharing pictures and video.

Why

- Because it contains a wealth of institutional memory, and we should archive what we want to keep.

How

- Techniques and tools for archiving and batch uploading Instagram materials.

What is Instagram?



Visual Content Platform

A social media platform owned by meta / Facebook and used for sharing images, videos and stories.



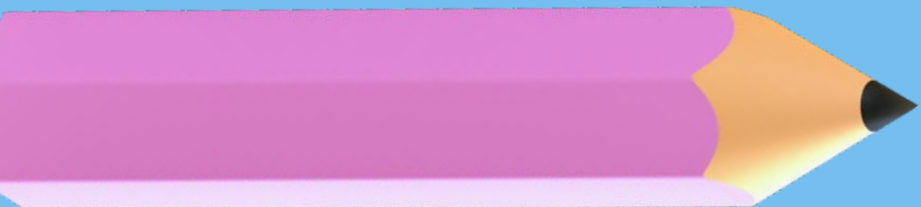
Ephemeral Content

Showcasing campus life, events, student activities and faculty accomplishments.

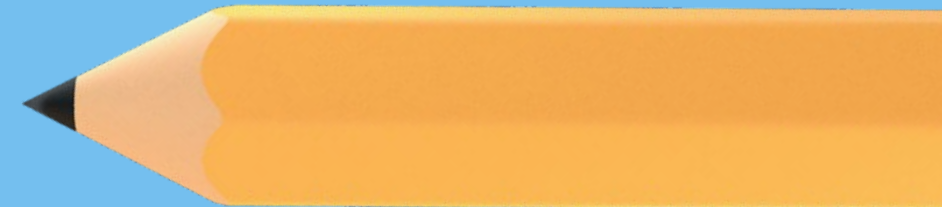


User Engagement

Features include likes, comments, hashtags and direct messaging.



Why keep it?



Providing Access

There are folks in my library who hadn't seen our cool renovation tour video because they don't have an Instagram account.



Adding to an Existing Collection

We have had a photo collection digitized from our archives, and adding born digital material is fun.



Ensuring Long Term Access

Trusting Instagram to hold on to all this data is folly. Social media is free because you and your attention is the product they sell to advertisers.

Increasing the
number of works
in my IR is a fun!



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IS
HUNGRY



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Goals and Opportunities



Repeatable Workflow

Developing a repeatable workflow to use and share with other IR folk.



Outreach

An easier ask to get other social media folk on campus to share their archive to grow the collection.



Spotlighting

Create an Instagram collection to share past events, student life and library initiatives for future reference. Act as a showcase for student social media work.

A Myriad of Ways To Save Instagram



Easiest and most official feeling

Instagram user official export / archive

Sketchy but easy
and you feel like a hacker

Break the TOS for Instagram and use a tool to
scrap and download the files.

Hardest and yet still sketchy?

Download from Instagram by hand.

I did it so you don't have to.



Individual Video Downloader

- If you google Instagram reels download or video downloader you find many options, any of the them might work, or give you a virus – I've used toolzu successfully but you can also use dev tools in chrome as explained here–
[youtube.com/watch?v=dte4ldPKOPA](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dte4ldPKOPA)

Sketchy Tool

- gallery-dl is a command line tool with which I used credentials from a burner Instagram account to scrap images from my University's account. This is against the TOS and my account was suspended.

Easiest and Official Feeling

- Log in to the posting account and visit-
<https://www.instagram.com/download/request>
and you get a zip of all the things

TOS Breach!

Your account has been suspended.

Free-SMS-Receive.COM



Language ▾



United States phone number

Receive SMS online for free [SMS service](#)

+18624017194 

(Click to copy this phone number)

- 1 Refresh this page to see the latest SMS messages.
- 2 There may be a 1-3 minute delay for the latest SMS.
- 3 Others can also retrieve the password through this number.

verify your account
with a phone number



Prove you're a
person with a
selfie



The things we do for our IR



S

STRENGTHS

Preserving institutional memory
Available for story telling
Improve accessibility and searchability of the Instagram posts.

W

WEAKNESSES

Finding a way to update the collection as Instagram posts continue being shared.

O

OPPORTUNITIES

Collaboration with other folks on campus and providing a new dataset for the study of social media.

T

THREATS

Overwhelming repository staff by requiring the managing of large volumes of media files. Possible copyright and privacy concerns.

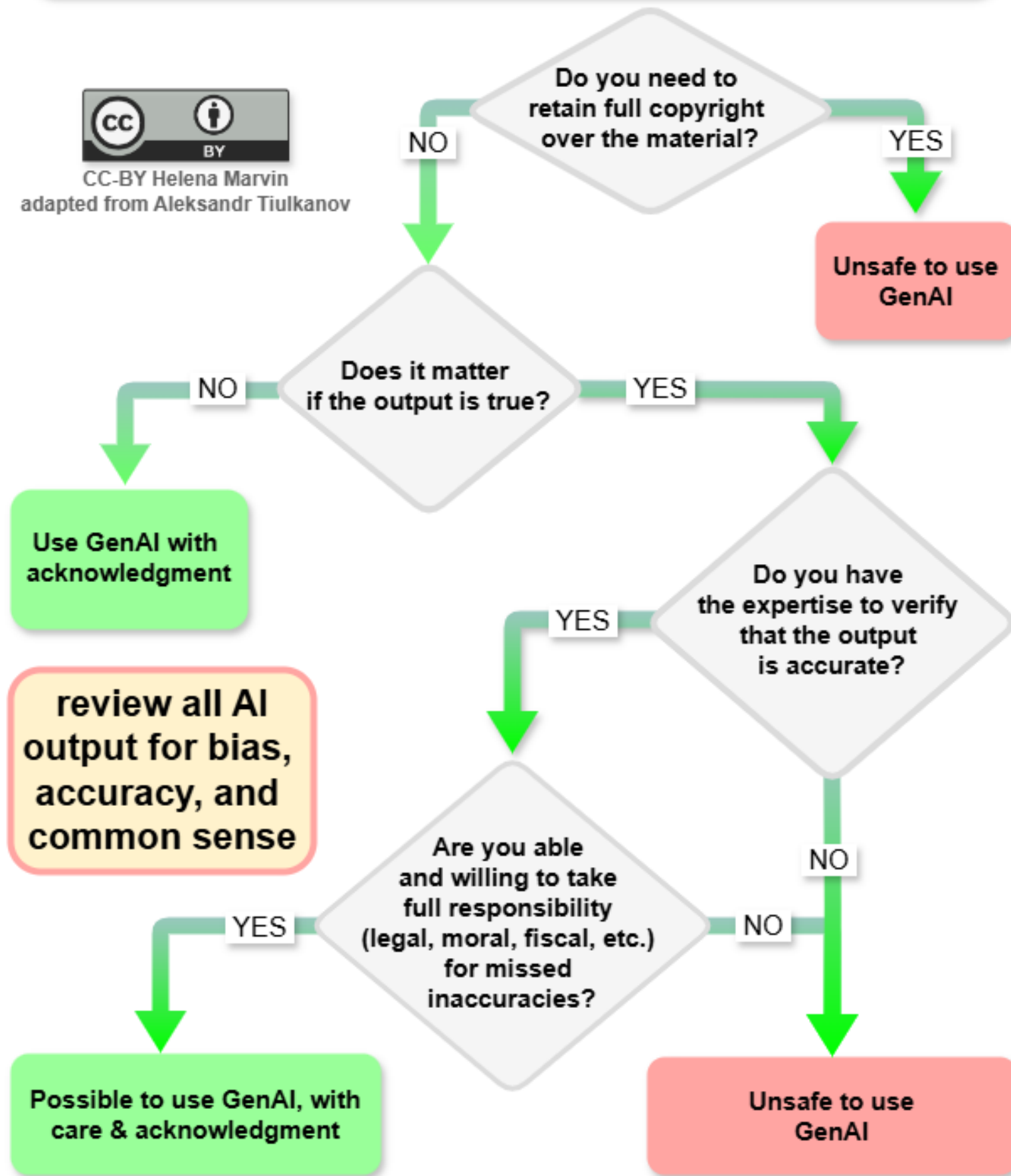
A blue laptop with a pink keyboard and a white screen. The screen displays the text "The tool lives in google colab so you don't have to install anything." in a red, serif font. The laptop is set against a yellow background with a teal wavy line in the top left corner.

The tool lives in
google colab so you
don't have to install
anything.

<https://github.com/e3la/i2dc>



When considering and permitted to use generative AI (GenAI) ask



Vibe Coding

Vibe Engineering

Build me an epic 3D game with cool features that'll make me \$\$\$!



Let's build a flying car game in Three.js, backend in Go, multiplayer with WebSocket...



Why is it not working?!



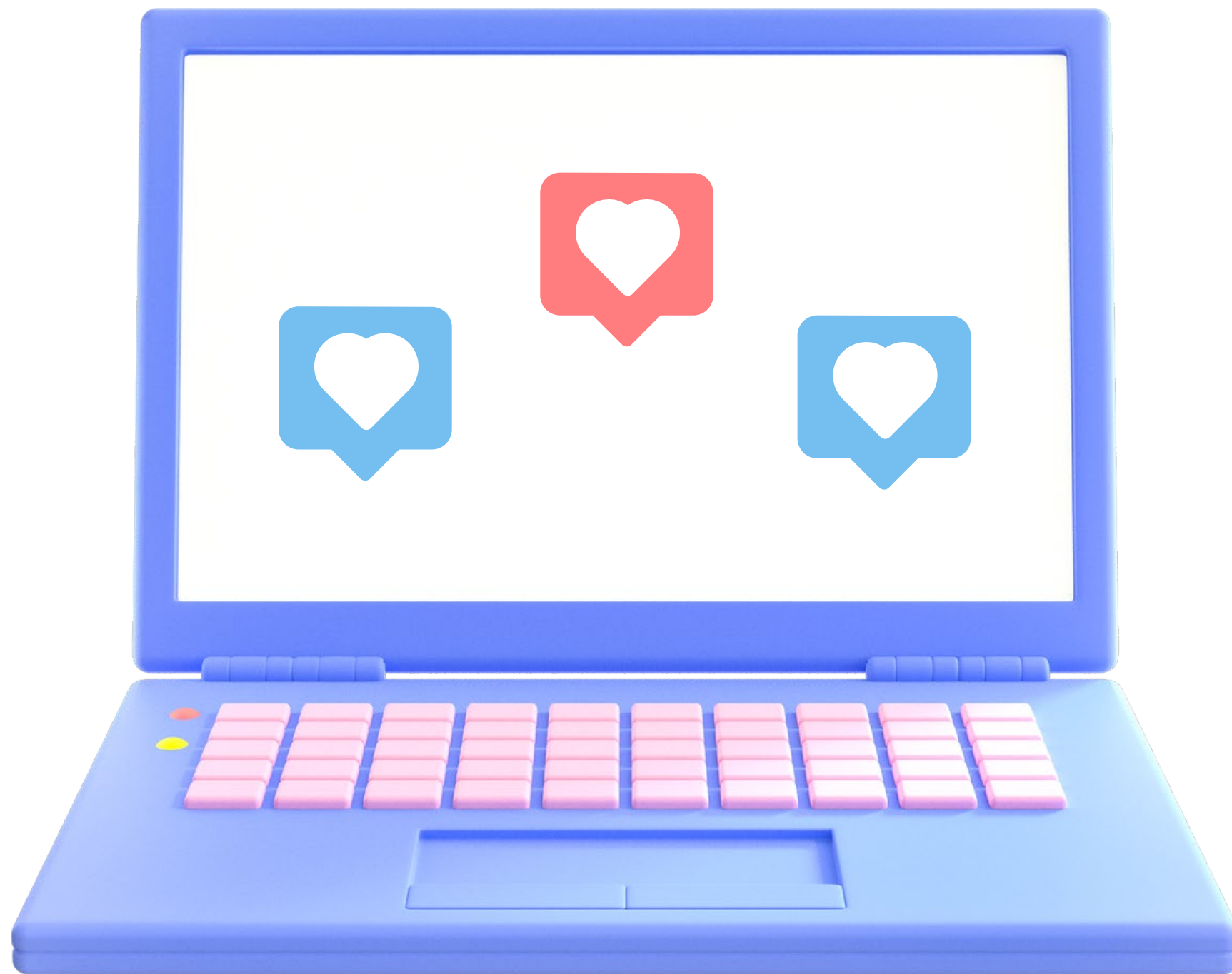
That was easy!



By: Aaditya Bhat



Types of Content in Instagram



Posts

standard, static images or videos shared on instagram

Reels

short, vertical video clips, typically up to 90 seconds long, that are discoverable through the Reels tab.

Stories

ephemeral
(disappearing after 24 hours)
image and video content
shared with followers

Batch Upload Posts Yes!



Posts

standard, static images or graphics a couple of videos shared on the profile feed.

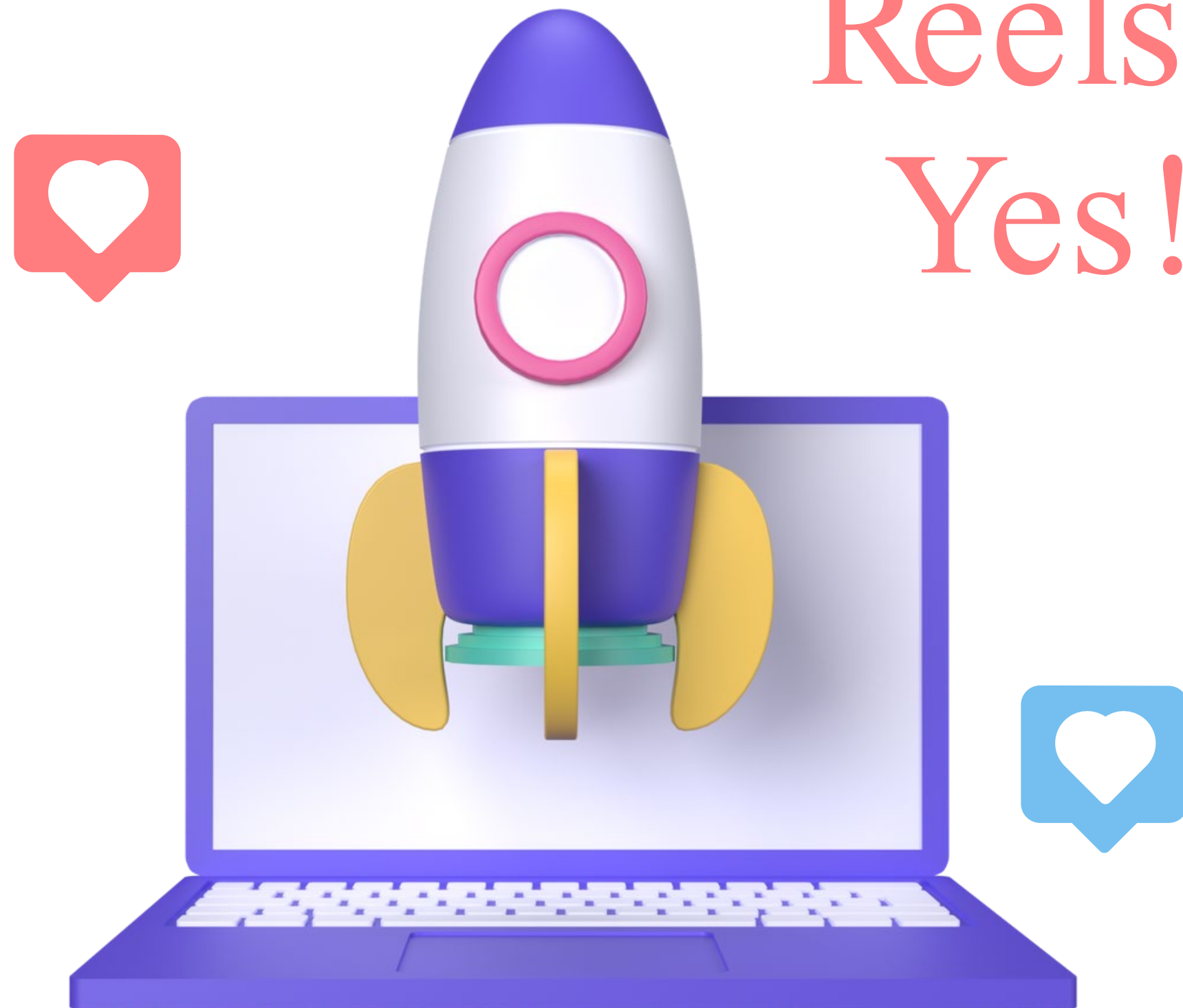
Photos

855 jpeg files

Videos

5 mp4 files

Batch Upload Reels Yes!



Reels

25 videos mp4s

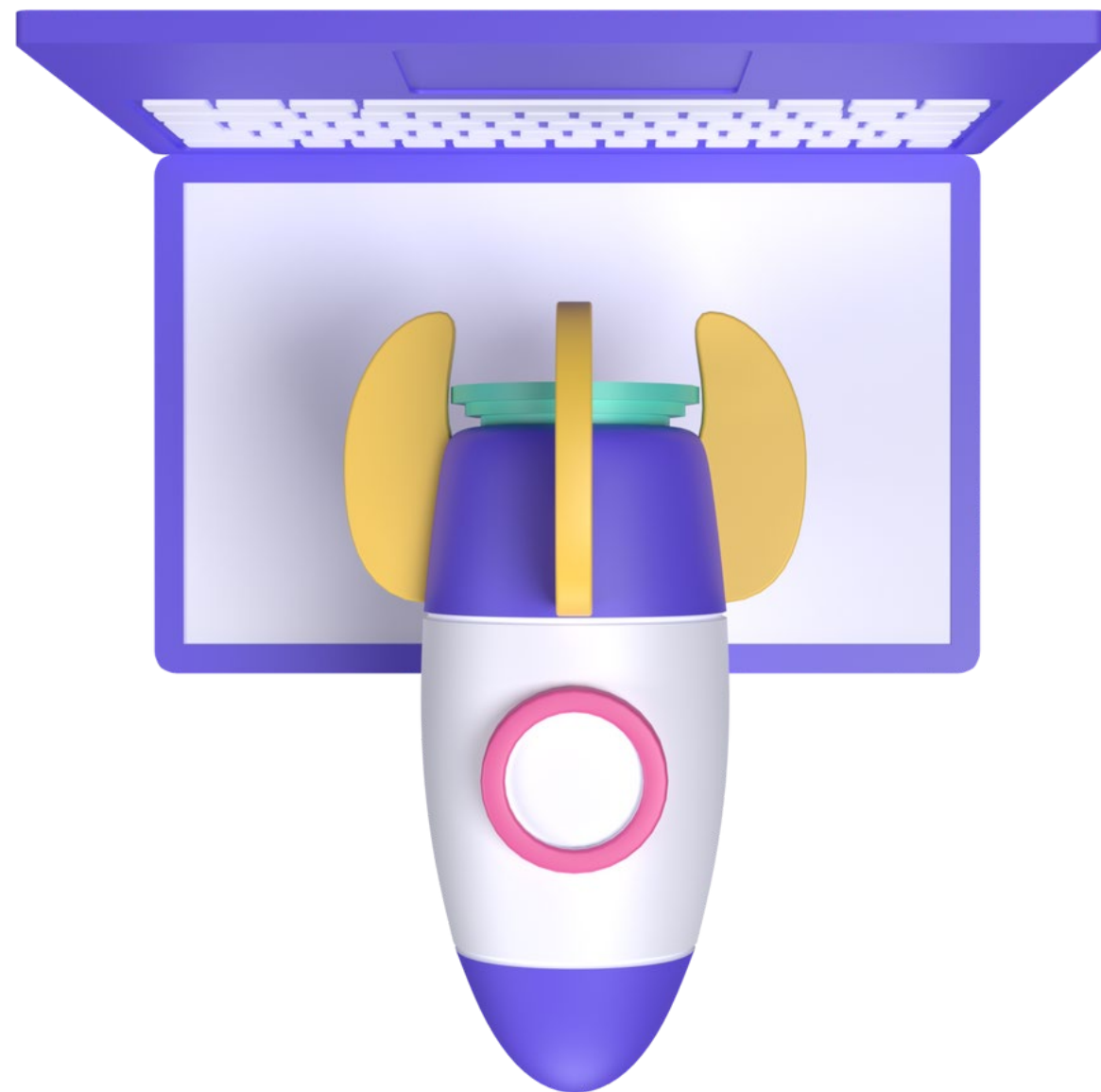
With subtitles?

8 srt files total:

2 surprise Spanish

6 glitches for the trash

No thank you, Stories!



Stories

Purposefully
ephemeral
(disappearing after 24
hours) image and video
shared with followers.

Some of the files look
weird and there is less
metadata.

I've chosen not to
upload stories.



Stories

Purposefully ephemeral
(disappearing after 24 hours) image and video shared with followers.

Some of the files look weird and there is minimal metadata.

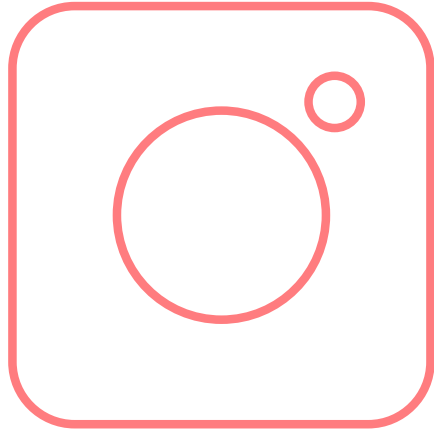
After review - I've chosen not to upload stories.

Where and what is the new collection

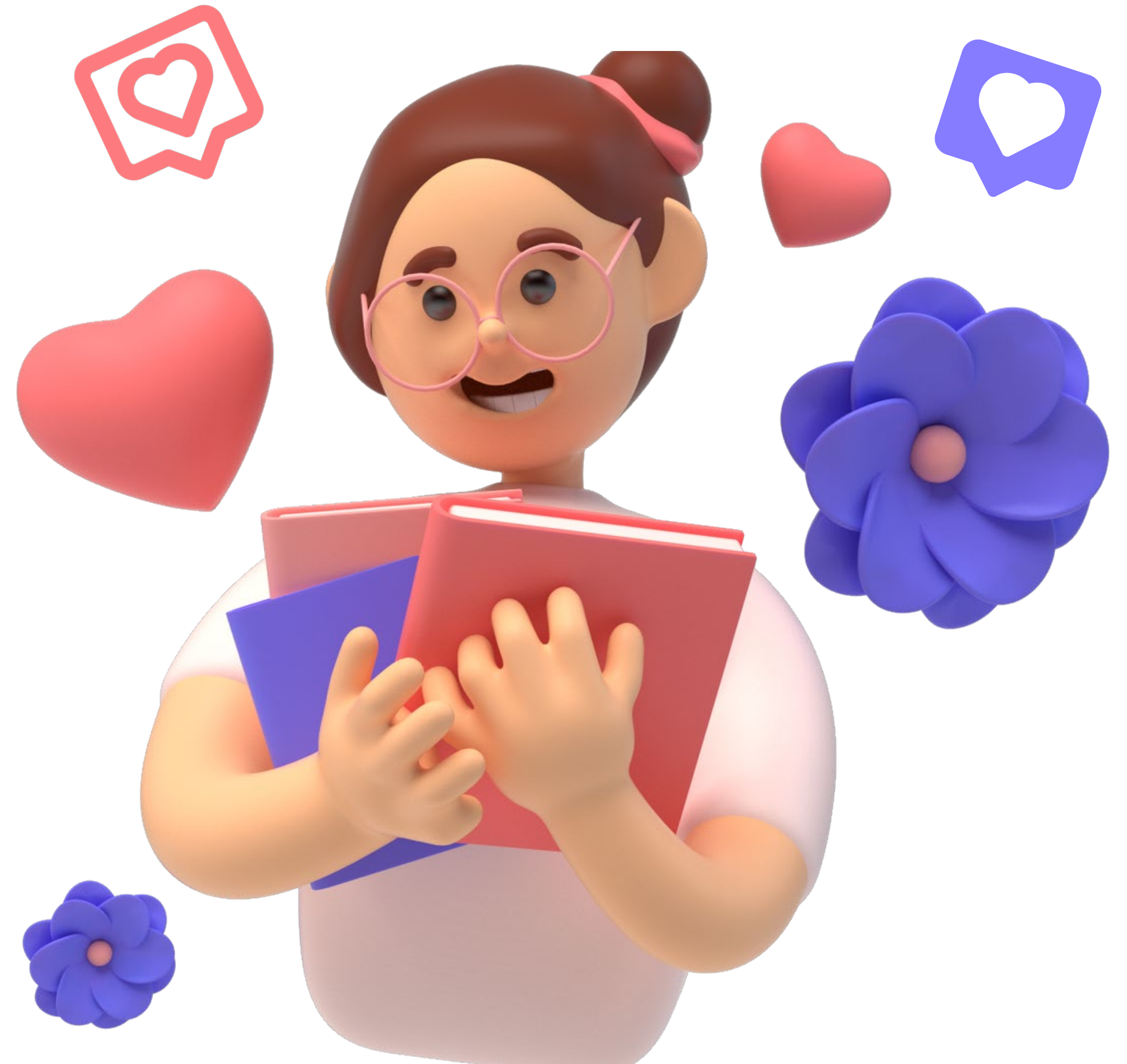
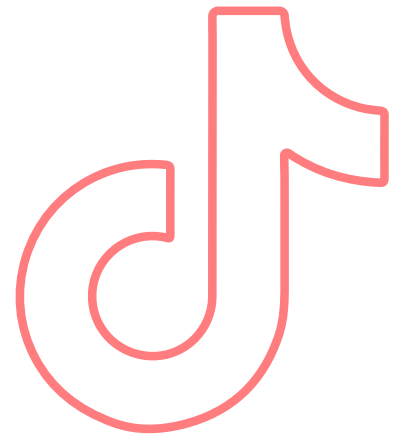
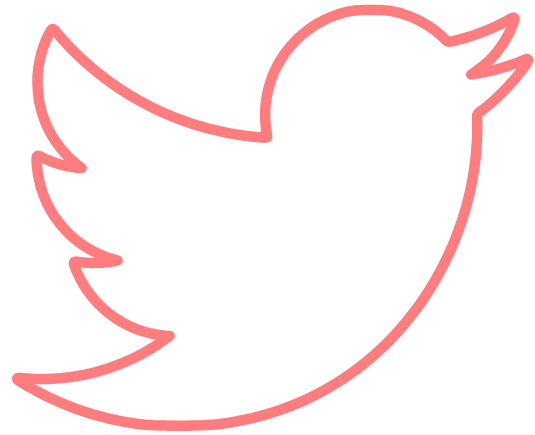
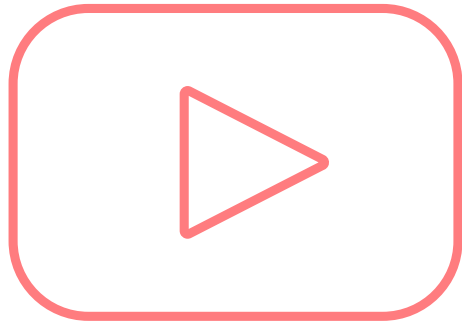
IRL.UMSL.EDU/INSTAGRAM

it's a book gallery
because videos





What next?





Thank you

Any Questions?

marvinh@ums1.edu



Credits

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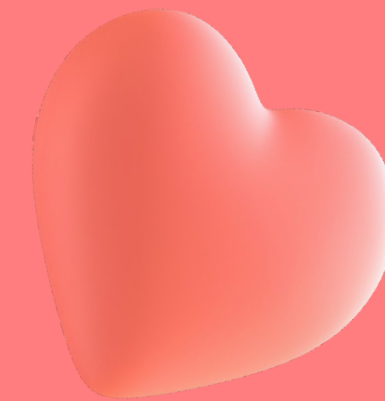
SlidesCarnival for the presentation template

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Thank you!